Student Roll Number: 20L-0961_____Student Name: Ammar Ahmed_____

Activity

Generate Ideas: Recycling Business Concepts

1. Spend a day searching the internet to find stories of entrepreneurs who started interesting businesses that are located in another country. Some good websites to begin with are:
   http://www.businessinsider.com/
   http://www.entrepreneur.com/
   http://www.google.com/
   http://www.businessesforsale.com/
2. As you read an article about each small business ask yourself some questions:
   - What is the primary need this company appears to be trying to fill?
   - Would the people in my community likely have a similar need for this type of business and could I introduce something similar locally?

   If the answers are "yes" then document the business concepts below:

Name of company # 1 EcoFiltro	City, country of headquarters: Guatemala City, Guatemala	Website https://ecofiltro.com.gt
Business concept & need being filled: EcoFiltro produces affordable, eco-friendly water filters made from clay, colloidal silver, and sawdust. The company addresses the need for clean drinking water in rural and underserved communities where access to safe water is limited.		
How I could improve this idea: Introduce a subscription-based model where customers can pay monthly for filter replacements and maintenance and partner with local governments or NGOs to distribute filters in areas with poor water quality.		

3. Another approach is to call a member of the family or a friend located far away and asks them if they know of any innovative or note-worthy businesses near where they live. Or if you are going to university far from home you can always just walk around town and see if there are any local businesses worth emulating back at home. Either way, write down a few notes about each idea so you can add these new business concepts to the interesting ones you learned about via the internet.

4. Repeat step 2 as you read articles or hear about other small businesses:
   - What is the primary need this additional company appears to be trying to fill?
   - Would the people in my community likely have a similar need for this type of business and could I introduce something similar locally? If answer is "yes" then document the business concept below.

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Name of company # 2 MyCabin	City, country of headquarters: Riga, Latvia	Website https://mycabin.ie
Business concept & need being filled: MyCabin builds and delivers Scandinavian-style, prefabricated tiny homes designed for affordability and sustainability. The company addresses the growing demand for eco-friendly and minimalist living spaces, particularly among young professionals and those seeking alternative housing solutions.		
How I could improve this idea: Adapt tiny homes for my region by designing climate-resistant structures suited to extreme weather conditions. Use locally sourced materials to reduce costs and support sustainable building practices. Explore a rent-to-own model, allowing lower-income individuals to afford their own small homes over time.		

5. Repeat this process in the spaces that follow:

Name of company # 3 Gjirafa	City, country of headquarters: Prishtina, Kosovo	Website https://www.aboutgjirafa.com
Business concept & need being filled: Gjirafa is a tech company that created a search engine and e-commerce platform tailored for the Balkan region. It addresses the need for localized online services in areas underserved by global tech giants.		
How I could improve this idea: Adapt the concept to my region by creating a localized platform for services like job postings, local business directories, or e-commerce for niche products. I will also integrate AI to personalize user experiences.		

Name of company # 4 Barefoot College	City, country of headquarters: Tiloniya, India	Website https://barefoot.college
Business concept & need being filled: Barefoot College trains rural women, often with little formal education, to become solar engineers. This empowers them to bring renewable energy solutions to their communities, addressing energy poverty.		
How I could improve this idea: Follow the same model in our community by focusing on different skills like water purification or sustainable farming. I will also partner with local organizations to fund training programs and create job opportunities.		

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Name of company # 5 Eazi-Apps	City, country of headquarters: Leicester, United Kingdom	Website https://www.eazi-apps.co.uk
Business concept & need being filled: It allows individuals to create cost-effective, high-quality mobile applications for businesses without needing technical expertise. It addresses the growing demand for digital solutions, particularly among small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) that lack the budget for custom app development.		
How I could improve this idea: Adapt platform for local businesses in my community. Integrate Urdu language support and local payment gateways to make the apps more user-friendly. I can also offer low cost training programs to local entrepreneurs to teach them how to use the platform and customize their apps to their needs.		

6. Review the business concepts listed above and circle the top concepts that you feel are most interesting and promising.

If you'd like to generate more business ideas then you may want to try:

- Combining two of your existing ideas together to create an interesting new idea
- Analyzing an industry that is rapidly growing or that you find interesting to seek what problems people in this industry may be facing and what opportunities may exist to solve these problems
- Re doing any of the four strategies already reviewed in this packet to generate even more ides

Home Task 1

Listing of ideas that you are interested

The key aim of this assignment is to generate at least 5 ideas that interest you. You should try to identify gaps and weaknesses in existing products/services available in the market. You can also observe your community of residence and think about key challenges or issues which your community is facing daily. After generating ideas of your interest, enlist them into the given template.

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Enlist your ideas

EcoFiltro – Affordable, eco-friendly water filters providing clean drinking water to underserved communities.

MyCabin – Prefabricated, sustainable tiny homes designed for affordable and minimalist living.

Gjirafa – localized search engine and e-commerce platform tailored for underserved regional markets.

Barefoot College – Training rural women, often with little formal education, to become solar engineers.

Eazi-Apps – A no-code mobile app development platform helping small businesses go digital easily.

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How to Quickly Evaluate Ideas

After you generate a good number of new business ideas you will need to determine which ideas are most promising and which ideas to cross off.

1. For each of the best business ideas you generated, write each idea in the BUSINESS IDEA sections of the following pages (one idea per section). This will make it easier to evaluate each idea quickly.
2. In the section below, write your answers clearly and concisely to the three key questions listed about your business idea.

BUSINESS IDEA # 1 – Clearly describe the idea in a few sentences: EcoFiltro: produce low-cost, eco-friendly water filters made from natural materials, addressing the need for clean drinking water in rural and underserved areas.	Rate Each answer from 1-10
a) What is the compelling need that is not currently being met: Many communities lack access to safe drinking water.	10
b) Who is the target market that has this need (demographics, characteristics, etc.) Rural and low-income households, NGOs, and disaster relief agencies.	9
c) Does this idea sound interesting and exciting to me, if so, why: The impact on public health and sustainability makes it a fulfilling venture.	9
Total Score (a+b+c)	28

3. The rate of your answers from 1-10 in the "Rate each answer from 1-10" column on the right. An Outstanding idea with a compelling need should be rated a 10, an idea with a clearly defined target market should be rated a 10, and an incredibly interesting and exciting idea should be rated a 10. Anything less should be rated lower. A rating of 1 is the lowest rating. Most answers will likely fall in between and should be rated accordingly. So, rate each answer listed above.
4. Add your three ratings together to comprise your total score (maximum total is 30) which you should write in the shaded TOTAL SCORE section above for future comparison.

BUSINESS IDEA # 2 – Clearly describe the idea in a few sentences: MyCabin: provide prefabricated, Scandinavian-style tiny homes that offer a sustainable and cost-effective housing solution for minimalist living.	Rate Each answer from 1-10
a) What is the compelling need that is not currently being met: Affordable Eco-Friendly homes	9
b)Who is the target market that has this need (demographics, characteristics, etc.) : Young professionals, eco-conscious individuals, and rural tourism providers.	8
c)Does this idea sound interesting and exciting to me, if so, why: The combination of sustainability, design, and affordability makes it a promising concept.	9
Total Score (a+b+c)	26

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BUSINESS IDEA # 3 – Clearly describe the idea in a few sentences: Gjirafa: provide a localized search engine and e-commerce platform tailored to regions underserved by global tech giants.	Rate Each answer from 1-10
a)What is the compelling need that is not currently being met: Many regions lack digital infrastructure tailored to their local language and culture	9
b)Who is the target market that has this need (demographics, characteristics, etc.) : Businesses and consumers in emerging markets with limited online service options.	9
c)Does this idea sound interesting and exciting to me, if so, why: The potential to revolutionize digital access for entire regions is exciting.	10
Total Score (a+b+c)	28
BUSINESS IDEA # 4 – Clearly describe the idea in a few sentences: Barefoot College: Barefoot College trains rural women, often with little formal education, to become solar engineers. This empowers them to bring renewable energy solutions to their communities, addressing energy poverty.	Rate Each answer from 1-10
a)What is the compelling need that is not currently being met: Many rural areas lack access to electricity, limiting education and economic growth.	9
b)Who is the target market that has this need (demographics, characteristics, etc.) : Rural women, NGOs, and organizations promoting renewable energy and women's empowerment.	9
c)Does this idea sound interesting and exciting to me, if so, why: The ability to create a social impact while advancing sustainable energy is inspiring.	9
Total Score (a+b+c)	27
BUSINESS IDEA # 5 – Clearly describe the idea in a few sentences: Eazi-Apps: no-code mobile app development platform that helps small businesses create and customize apps affordably, without requiring technical skills.	Rate Each answer from 1-10
a)What is the compelling need that is not currently being met: Many small businesses struggle to afford or develop custom apps.	8
b)Who is the target market that has this need (demographics, characteristics, etc.) : Small business owners, freelancers, and startups looking to digitize operations.	9
c)Does this idea sound interesting and exciting to me, if so, why: Helping businesses grow through affordable tech solutions is appealing.	9
Total Score (a+b+c)	26

Generating and Screening Ideas

Step 1: Expand your list if possible: As you have already developed a list of 5 ideas according to your interest. Now think about your personal interests, your desired lifestyle, your values, what you feel you are likely to do very well, and contributions you would like to make.

I have a strong passion for technology, sustainability, and social impact, which drives my business ideas toward eco-friendly solutions, tech platforms, and skill development initiatives.
I aspire to build scalable businesses that are both profitable and impactful, enabling me to merge financial success with meaningful change.
I prioritize innovation, accessibility, and sustainability, making sure my ideas meet real-world needs while being practical.
With my background in Data Science and AI, I have a knack for creating tech-driven solutions and making decisions based on data.
1. Digital Payment Platform for SMEs: A localized mobile payment system (like M-Pesa) that helps small businesses in my community accept digital payments easily.
2. Plastic Waste Recycling for Construction: Converting plastic waste into low-cost construction materials,

Step 2: Ask at least three people who know you well to look at your list, and revise your list to reflect any new ideas emerging from this exchange.

1. A Business Mentor – Encouraged me to concentrate on ideas that have great scalability and minimal entry barriers, recommending that I prioritize Eazi-Apps and Gjirafa.

2. A University Peer – Considered EcoFiltro and Barefoot College to be the most impactful because of their social benefits, but noted that securing funding might be difficult.

3. A Family Member – Expressed enthusiasm for MyCabin but raised concerns about possible regulatory hurdles and high expenses in local markets.

EcoFiltro and Gjirafa seem to have the highest impact and scalability.

MyCabin needs significant adaptation to local markets.

A digital payment platform could complement Eazi-Apps.

Recycling-based businesses could be added to target environmental concerns.

Step 3: Jot down insights, observations, and conclusions that have emerged about your business ideas or your personal preferences. Which ones solve the greatest pain point/aggravation/frustration for which you (and others you have spoken with) would pay a significant premium to eliminate?

The biggest pain points addressed include EcoFiltro (providing clean water), Gjirafa (offering localized digital access), and Eazi-Apps (delivering affordable technology for businesses).

The strongest business potential lies with Eazi-Apps and Gjirafa, as they are scalable, technology-driven, and straightforward to implement.

For social impact, EcoFiltro and Barefoot College stand out, showing a high likelihood of attracting funding from NGOs or government entities.

Challenges and barriers include MyCabin (facing cost and regulatory issues), Eazi-Apps (navigating a competitive market), and Barefoot College (which needs robust partnerships).

Next steps involve prioritizing EcoFiltro and Gjirafa while looking into ways to incorporate digital payments into Eazi-Apps.